- On development machines, the User Secrets Manager is a more convenient tool than using environment variables. It stores secrets in your operating system's user profile, outside the project folder, reducing the risk of accidentally exposing secrets in your code repository.
- Be aware that neither environment variables nor the User Secrets Manager tool encrypts secrets. They merely store them in locations that are less likely to be made public, as they're outside your project folder.
- File-based providers such as the JSON provider can reload configuration values automatically when the file changes, allowing you to update configuration values in real time without restarting your app.
- Use strongly typed POCO options classes to access configuration in your app. Using strongly typed options reduces coupling in your app and ensures that classes are dependent only on the configuration values they use.
- Use the `Configure<T>()` extension method in `ConfigureServices` to bind your POCO options objects to `ConfigurationSection`. Alternatively, you can configure `IOptions<T>` objects in code instead of using configuration values by passing a lambda to the `Configure()` method.
- You can inject the `IOptions<T>` interface into your services by using DI. You can access the strongly typed options object on the `Value` property. `IOptions<T>` values are registered in DI as singletons, so they remain the same even if the underlying configuration changes.